

A PERSONAL VIEW FROM TAIWAN

A GOOD EXCUSE.

Hacktivism, inside
and outside government.



An excuse to step outside
everyday constraints.

FIELD NOTES

01 / TW

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mashbean

Medical doctor.
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SUBJECT

How do we give
people room
to try?

GOVERNMENT ↔ GOV

MY TECHNICAL ESTIMATE

ONE ENGINEER.
TWO WEEKS.

“This doesn’t look that difficult.”

MY COLLEAGUES’ RESPONSE

“Mashbean,
you’re being
very naive.”

Government doesn’t work like that.

CHANGE REQUEST

Code
change



THE PART I HADN’T COUNTED

Accountability
& procurement

Someone has to be able to approve it.



RELEASE

Live
service

The code was never the only thing they were waiting for.

Suddenly, there's *room to do something.*

“
I, as president,
support reform.

Tsai Ing-wen

27 July 2019



2019 award ceremony · Office of the President, Taiwan

Senior support



START HERE

**A frontline
problem**



A SHARED TEAM

**Across departments.
Open to people outside.**

A relationship can begin before a contract.

Did they keep working together?

2018 WINNER / EMERGENCY CARE

One-Stop Emergency Care

救急救難一站通

01

Ambulance
care

National Fire Agency × health ministry × NCDR

02

Hospital
treatment

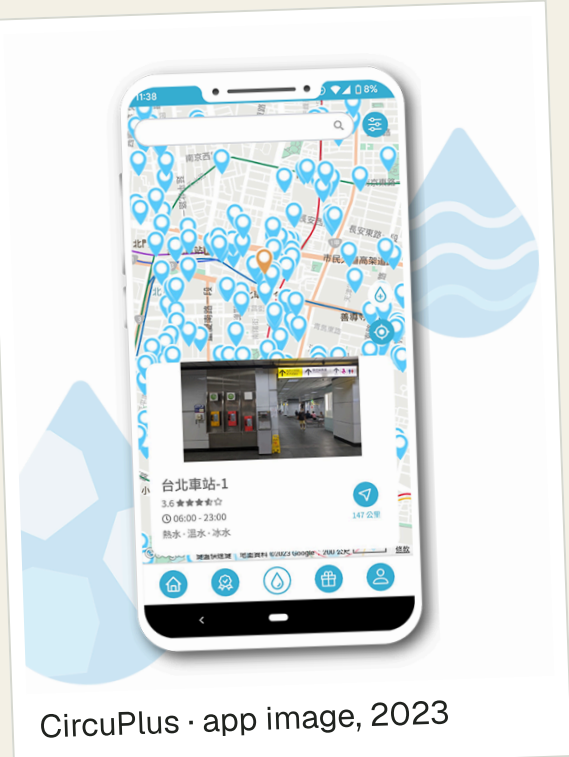
03

Patient
outcomes

20

cities & counties

Automated data
transfers
2024 results · NCDR



CircuPlus · app image, 2023

2020 WINNER / CIRCUPLUS

Feng Cha

An empty bottle.
A place to refill it.

Already a civic project
before the hackathon.

6,000 → 15,000+

Refill points · 2020 → team report, 2025

2021 WINNER / LASS

A continuing place at the table.

Shared maps and local knowledge
in Touqian River governance.

Water Resources Agency partnership since 2019



Collaboration meeting · Water Resources
Agency

AFTER LEAVING THE MINISTRY

I couldn't wait
to *hack on*
my own project.

There is no reason the work should end
when my job does.

MY INTERPRETATION

**Institutionalized
hacktivism.**

*When an exception becomes
a new way of working.*

If I can help, come and find me. mashbean.net ↗



My wallet work after government
Published project screenshot · September
2026